



POLICY

U.S. Soccer will investigate any possible fraudulent or dishonest use or misuse of U.S. Soccer resources or property by management, staff, volunteers, or members. Anyone found to have engaged in a fraudulent or dishonest conduct is subject to disciplinary action by U.S. Soccer.

All members of the U.S. Soccer community are encouraged to report possible fraudulent or dishonest conduct. An employee should report his or her concerns to a supervisor or manager. If for any reason an employee finds it difficult to report his or her concern to a manager or supervisor, the employee can report it directly to the Chief Executive Officer, Chief Operating Officer, Legal Department, Human Resources Department, or Integrity Hotline: (312) 528-7004 or www.ussoccer.com/report-a-concern.

Managers or supervisors are required to report suspected fraudulent or dishonest conduct to one of the individuals or departments listed above.

DEFINITIONS

'Baseless Allegations': Allegations made with reckless disregard for their truth or falsity. People making such allegations will be subject to discipline.

'Fraudulent or Dishonest Conduct': A deliberate act or failure to act with the intention of obtaining an unauthorized benefit. Examples of such conduct include, but are not limited to:

- Forgery or alteration of documents
- Unauthorized alteration or manipulation of computer files
- Fraudulent financial reporting
- Pursuit of a benefit or advantage in violation of U.S. Soccer's conflict of interest policy
- Misappropriation or misuse of U.S. Soccer's resources, such as funds, supplies, or other assets
- Authorizing or receiving compensation for goods not received or services not performed
- Authorizing or receiving compensation for hours not worked

'Whistleblower': Any person who reports to a manager, supervisor, the Chief Executive Officer, Legal Department, or Human Resources Department an activity or other conduct which that person believes to be unlawful, fraudulent, or dishonest.

RIGHTS AND RESPONSIBILITIES (FOR MANAGERS)

Managers or supervisors are required to report suspected fraudulent or dishonest conduct to one of the individuals or departments listed above. In addition, managers or supervisors are responsible for maintaining a system of management controls, which detect and deter fraudulent or dishonest conduct. Failure by a manager or supervisor to report misconduct within the scope of this policy may result in adverse personnel action against the manager or supervisor, up to and including dismissal. The appropriate parties listed above are available to assist management in recognizing improper conduct.

Reasonable care should be taken in dealing with suspected misconduct to avoid:

- Baseless allegations
- Premature notice to persons suspected of misconduct and/or disclosure of suspected misconduct to others not involved with the investigation
- Violations of a person's rights under law



Accordingly, a manager or supervisor faced with a suspected misconduct:

- Should not contact the person suspected to further investigate the matter or demand restitution
- Should not discuss the case with anyone other than the appropriate parties listed above.
- Should direct all inquiries from any attorney retained by the suspected individual to the General Counsel
- Should direct any inquiries from the media to the Federation spokesperson

WHISTLEBLOWER PROTECTION

U.S. Soccer prohibits any intimidation, harassment, discrimination, adverse employment consequence, or other retaliation against Whistleblowers. U.S. Soccer will use its best efforts to protect Whistleblowers against such retaliation, as described below. It cannot guarantee confidentiality, however, and there is no such thing as an "unofficial" or "off the record" report. U.S. Soccer will keep the Whistleblower's identity confidential, unless (1) the person agrees to be identified; (2) identification is necessary to allow U.S. Soccer or law enforcement officials to investigate or respond effectively to the report; (3) identification is required by law; or (4) the person accused of policy violations is entitled to the information as a matter of legal right.

U.S. Soccer employees, staff, director, or other affiliated persons may not retaliate against a Whistleblower, including with the intent or effect of adversely affecting his or her terms or conditions of employment (including but not limited to, threats of physical harm, loss of job, punitive work assignments, or impact on salary or wages).

Examples of reported conduct that would be protected under this policy includes, but is not limited to, U.S. Soccer's or any person's lack of compliance with (i) the Ted Stevens Olympic and Amateur Sports Act; (ii) U.S. Soccer policies, procedures, and Bylaws; (iii) the USOPC's policies, procedures, and Bylaws; and (iv) state and Federal laws.

Whistleblowers must be cautious to avoid Baseless Allegations (as defined in this policy).

Whistleblowers who believe that they have been retaliated against may file a written complaint with the Chief Executive Officer, Legal Department, or Human Resources Department, or Integrity Hotline. Reports to departments will be initially investigated by the department to which the report was made, which ensures the initial investigation is managed by the department the Whistleblower considers to be disinterested in the matter. Reports made to the Integrity Hotline will be referred to the Legal Department for initial investigation. Reports made to individual persons, such as managers or the Chief Executive Officer, shall be referred to the Legal Department for initial investigation.

The CEO/Secretary General or her/his designee in the case of a conflict will make the determination regarding the Whistleblower's complaint. All determinations will be made by only disinterested individuals. Any person with an interest in or connection to the Whistleblower's complaint shall recuse himself or herself from all discussions and decisions related to the complaint.

As determined by the CEO/Secretary General, a proven complaint of retaliation shall result in a proper remedy for the person harmed, and, the initiation of disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal, against the retaliating person. This protection from retaliation is not intended to prohibit managers or supervisors from taking action, including disciplinary action, in the usual scope of their duties and based on valid performance-related factors.